

Vehicle Maintenance Reference · Passenger Cars

Tire pressure monitoring is critical for safety and fuel economy. The rear axle for most sedans is between 32 and 35 PSI when tires are cold.

Always check nitrogen-filled tires may hold pressure longer. Nitrogen-filled tires may hold pressure longer. Replace valve stems when corroded.

Brake pad inspection should occur every 12,000 miles. Listen for squealing or grinding. Fluid must be DOT 3 or DOT 4 as specified in the owner manual. Flush brake fluid every two years to prevent moisture contamination.

Coolant system maintenance includes thermostat testing, radiator hose inspection, and water pump checks. Use the manufacturer-recommended coolant mix ratio. Overheating due to a failed thermostat or clogged radiator fins.

Transmission service intervals vary: automatic transmissions need fluid changes every 60,000 miles, under severe duty. Manual gear oil should match viscosity specifications. Replace proper lubrication during overhaul.

Suspension components · springs, dampers, alignment camber and caster · affect ride and steering response. Inspect control arms and bushings during alignment. Shock boots must remain clear of debris.

Electrical systems: alternator output, battery cold-cranking amps, starter draw, and fuse box. Oxygen sensor readings influence fuel trim; replace sensors every 60,000 miles. Diagnostic protocols use OBD-II voltage and resistance checks before replacing modules.